CORE_LOCKS

Object locking and source backup
for shared Oracle schemas

> Two developers open the same package on a shared dev schema. Both compile. The second one wins, the first one's morning is gone, and nothing tells either of them. You find out days later, when the fix you wrote is not there any more.

What it does

One `AFTER DDL ON SCHEMA` trigger catches every compile, records who ran it, and refuses the DDL when somebody else holds a live lock on that object. The second developer gets an error naming the first one and the lock id, instead of a surprise.

Compile an object and it is yours for 20 minutes. Keep compiling and it stays yours. Stop, and the lock expires on its own, so nobody is locked out because a colleague went to lunch and forgot.

Why this one

— **Four objects.** One table, one package, one trigger, one job. That is the whole install.

— **No APEX application** to build, host or maintain. `APEX_STRING` has to be reachable, but there is no app, no pages, no workspace to keep alive.

— **No framework.** The same feature inside CORE23 pulls in the `CORE` and `CORE_CUSTOM` packages plus the `CORE_LOGS` table, about 6,300 lines. This version cuts that away and keeps the idea.

— **Your source, kept.** Every lock row stores a copy of the object as it was compiled, so the table is also a backup and a record of who changed what.

— **More than packages.** Tables, views, materialized views, package bodies, procedures, functions and triggers.

What it costs you

It is a schema level DDL trigger and it raises. That is the point, and it is also the risk. A bug in the package, a missing `DBMS_CRYPTO` grant, or a developer connecting without an identifiable username will fail every DDL in that schema, including the DDL you need to fix it. Put it on a dev schema first and read the escape hatch before it goes anywhere that matters.

It also changes the day for everyone on the schema, not just you. That is a team decision, not a personal one.

Where it came from

Pulled out of the CORE23 framework and cut free of it, so you can run the locking without adopting anything else. Four objects, about 560 lines of SQL, and you can read all of it in one sitting.